

# Project Upstream

M&A Deal-Sourcing CRM | Non-Technical User Guide

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# 1 | Getting Started and Logging In

Project Upstream is a purpose-built CRM for M&A investment-banking teams. It replaces the spreadsheets your firm used to track deal targets, email outreach, and follow-up schedules -- bringing everything into one connected, always-up-to-date system.

## Accessing the Application

**Web address:** <https://frontend-navy-pi-11.vercel.app>  
**API / back-end:** <https://upstream-api-production-0a58.up.railway.app>

Open the web address in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari). No download or installation is required.

## Logging In

When you visit the site you are taken directly to the Login page. Enter the email address and password provided by your partner or admin. Your session is kept securely in the browser -- you will stay logged in until you sign out or your session expires (30 minutes of inactivity).

### NOTE

Passwords are never stored in plain text and are always encrypted. If you forget your password, ask your Partner to reset it.

## Demo / Seed Accounts (password for all: Passw0rd!)

| Email address            | Role      | Scope         |
|--------------------------|-----------|---------------|
| partner@upstream.test    | Partner   | All mandates  |
| analyst1@upstream.test   | Analyst   | Assigned only |
| analyst2@upstream.test   | Analyst   | Assigned only |
| associate1@upstream.test | Associate | Assigned only |
| associate2@upstream.test | Associate | Assigned only |

## Signing Out

Click your name or avatar in the top-right corner, then choose Sign Out. Your session cookie is cleared immediately.

## 2 | Roles and Permissions

Every user in Upstream belongs to exactly one of three roles. The role controls which mandates they can see and which actions they can perform.

### The Three Roles

|                  |                                                                                                                         |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Partner</b>   | Full visibility across all mandates. Creates and manages mandates, assigns team members, and views firm-wide analytics. |
| <b>Associate</b> | Sees assigned mandates only. Manages companies and contacts on those mandates, and logs all outreach activity.          |
| <b>Analyst</b>   | Same scope as Associate. Sees assigned mandates only; logs outreach and tracks follow-ups day-to-day.                   |

### Permission Matrix (Y = allowed, N = not allowed)

| Action                                  | Partner | Assoc. | Analyst |
|-----------------------------------------|---------|--------|---------|
| View ALL mandates (firm-wide)           | Y       | N      | N       |
| View ASSIGNED mandates                  | Y       | Y      | Y       |
| Create a new mandate                    | Y       | N      | N       |
| Edit mandate name / details             | Y       | N      | N       |
| Archive or unarchive a mandate          | Y       | N      | N       |
| Assign analysts to a mandate            | Y       | N      | N       |
| Add or edit a company                   | Y       | Y      | Y       |
| Archive a company                       | Y       | Y      | Y       |
| Add or edit contacts                    | Y       | Y      | Y       |
| Log outreach events                     | Y       | Y      | Y       |
| View the Schedule work queue            | Y       | Y      | Y       |
| View Dashboard KPIs                     | Y       | Y      | Y       |
| View Analytics -- overview and sources  | Y       | Y      | Y       |
| View Analytics -- per-analyst breakdown | Y       | N      | N       |
| Manage team members                     | Y       | N      | N       |

#### NOTE

All data is firm-scoped. Every user sees only their own firm's data. No information is ever shared or visible across different firms.

## 3 | Dashboard -- Your Daily Summary

The Dashboard is the first page you see after logging in. It gives you an at-a-glance health check of all outreach activity within your visible mandates.

### KPI Cards (the five headline numbers)

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|                             |                                                                                |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Total Companies</b>      | Total non-archived companies across all visible mandates.                      |
| <b>Responded %</b>          | Percentage of companies that have replied (any positive response).             |
| <b>Needs First Outreach</b> | Companies not yet contacted -- no initial email has been sent.                 |
| <b>Due This Week</b>        | Companies whose next follow-up falls within the next 7 days.                   |
| <b>Overdue</b>              | Companies whose follow-up date has already passed. Shown in red when non-zero. |

### Status Mix Chart (Donut)

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A donut chart shows how companies are distributed across the six pipeline statuses: Not Contacted, Contacted, Responded, Interested, Declined, Bounced. Use this to understand pipeline health at a glance.

### Response Rate by Bucket (Bar Chart)

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A bar chart breaks response rate down by 'bucket' -- the internal category label applied to each company. This helps identify which segments or deal types are generating the best responses.

### Due This Week Mini-List

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Below the charts, the dashboard lists up to 8 companies whose follow-up is due this week. Each row shows the company name, its current status badge, and how many days remain (or how many days overdue). Click a company name to jump directly to its detail page.

## 4 | Mandates -- Managing Deals and Engagements

A Mandate represents a deal or client engagement your firm is working on -- for example, 'Sell-Side Advisory for Acme Manufacturing' or 'Capital Raise for GreenTech Ventures'. Everything in Upstream is organised under a mandate: companies, contacts, and outreach all belong to a mandate.

### Mandate Types

|                      |                                                                            |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sell-Side</b>     | Your firm advises a seller. Companies are potential buyers.                |
| <b>Buy-Side</b>      | Your firm advises a buyer. Companies are acquisition targets.              |
| <b>Capital Raise</b> | Your firm helps a client raise capital. Companies are potential investors. |

### Mandate Statuses

|                   |                                          |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------|
| <b>ACTIVE</b>     | Mandate is live and outreach is ongoing. |
| <b>ON HOLD</b>    | Work paused temporarily.                 |
| <b>CLOSED</b>     | Mandate completed successfully.          |
| <b>TERMINATED</b> | Mandate ended before completion.         |

### Creating a Mandate (Partner only)

- 1 Go to Mandates**  
Click Mandates in the left sidebar navigation.
- 2 Click New Mandate**  
Fill in the mandate name, type (Sell-Side / Buy-Side / Capital Raise), and an optional description.
- 3 Save**  
The mandate is created and appears in the list.
- 4 Assign team**  
Open the mandate, go to Assignments, and add the analysts and associates who will work on it.

### Viewing Mandates

All users see the Mandates list page. Partners see every mandate. Analysts and Associates see only mandates they have been assigned to. Each card shows the mandate name, type, status, and a quick summary of total company counts.

### Editing and Archiving (Partner only)

Edit any mandate field (name, description, status) by opening the mandate and clicking Edit. Archiving hides the mandate from all views and work queues without deleting any data. A mandate can be unarchived at any time.

## 5 | Companies -- Targets, Buyers and Investors

A Company is any organisation you are reaching out to as part of a mandate. Depending on the mandate type, companies may be Targets, Buyers, or Investors. Each company has its own profile, outreach history, contacts, and cadence schedule.

### Company Statuses (the pipeline)

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|               |                                                         |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| NOT CONTACTED | Added to the list; outreach has not yet started.        |
| CONTACTED     | Initial email sent; awaiting a response.                |
| RESPONDED     | Company replied. Follow-up cadence stops automatically. |
| INTERESTED    | Positive signal received; active discussion ongoing.    |
| DECLINED      | Company passed on the opportunity. Cadence stops.       |
| BOUNCED       | Email bounced. Cadence stops.                           |

### Adding a Company

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Open a mandate, then click Add Company. Fill in the company name, type (Target / Buyer / Investor), optional fields (sector, geography, revenue range, bucket), source, source quality, and the cadence interval (how many days between follow-ups, e.g. 7). Saving creates the company and its outreach schedule simultaneously.

### Company Detail Page

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Each company has a dedicated detail page with these sections:

- Header -- name, status badge, type, sector, geography, revenue range.
- Outreach History -- a complete chronological log of every email, call, LinkedIn message, meeting, and note. This list is permanent and can never be edited or deleted.
- Contacts -- people at this company (see Section 6).
- Cadence -- current follow-up status showing days remaining, next due date, or overdue indicator.
- Log Outreach button -- opens the log panel directly from this page.

### Source and Source Quality

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Every company records where the lead came from (Proprietary, Public, Referral, or Imported) and an optional quality rating (High / Medium / Low). These fields feed directly into the Analytics Sources report, helping you identify your most productive lead channels.

### Editing and Archiving Companies

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Any team member assigned to the mandate can edit a company's profile fields. Archiving removes it from all active lists and the Schedule work queue -- the data is preserved and can be restored.

## 6 | Contacts -- People at Companies

A Contact is a named individual at a company -- the actual person you are emailing or calling. Contacts let you keep precise records of who said what, their title, phone number, and LinkedIn profile.

### Adding a Contact

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From any Company detail page, scroll to the Contacts section and click Add Contact. Required fields: first name and last name. Optional: job title, email address, phone number, LinkedIn URL, and engagement type (Buy-Side, Sell-Side, Investor, Advisor, Other).

### Primary Contact

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You can mark one contact at a company as the Primary Contact. Their name then appears in company list views and reports, so you always know the key relationship for each company at a glance. Only one contact per company can be primary at any time.

### Editing Contacts

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Edit any contact field directly from the contact card on the company page. Archiving a contact hides them from the active list while preserving the record.

**NOTE**

Contacts are firm-scoped, meaning the same individual can appear in multiple mandates under your firm without duplication of their core record in a future release. Today each company has its own contact list.

## 7 | Schedule -- Your Outreach Work Queue

The Schedule page is the analyst's daily driver. It shows every company that needs attention right now, organised into three clear sections.

### Section 1 -- Needs First Outreach

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Companies where the initial email has never been sent. The cadence clock has not yet started for these. Your job: send the first email and then log it in Upstream so the system starts tracking the follow-up schedule.

### Section 2 -- Due Follow-Ups (next 7 days)

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Companies that have been contacted but whose next follow-up falls within the next 7 days. Sorted with the most urgent (soonest due) at the top. Each row shows how many days remain and the topic of outreach ('regarding' field).

### Section 3 -- Overdue

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Companies whose follow-up date has already passed. These are highlighted in red. Action is needed immediately -- send the follow-up and log it.

### How the Cadence Clock Works

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When you log the first 'Initial Email' event for a company, the clock starts. Upstream calculates the next follow-up date by adding the cadence interval (set when the company was added, e.g. 7 days) to the date of that last event. Every time you log a new follow-up, the due date resets forward. The clock stops automatically when the company status reaches Responded, Declined, or Bounced.

#### NOTE

All cadence dates are computed in IST (India Standard Time, UTC+5:30). The initial-email date is permanently fixed once set and cannot be changed, ensuring an accurate and auditable schedule history.

### Schedule Stats Bar

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At the top of the Schedule page, four counters give you an overview: total active schedules, total needing initial outreach, total due this week, and total overdue.

### Logging from the Schedule Page

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Each row on the Schedule page has a 'Log outreach' button. Clicking it opens the quick-log panel pre-filled with the correct event type: 'Initial Email' for first-contact companies and 'Follow-Up' for the rest.

## 8 | Logging Outreach and Tracking Activity

Every interaction with a company -- emails, calls, LinkedIn messages, meetings, and internal notes -- is recorded as an Outreach Event. These events form the permanent, tamper-proof history of all activity.

### Event Types

|                      |                                                                                  |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Initial Email</b> | The very first email to a company. Sets the cadence clock. Can only happen once. |
| <b>Follow-Up</b>     | Subsequent emails or any contact after the initial email.                        |
| <b>Response</b>      | The company replied positively. Marks status as Responded and stops the cadence. |
| <b>Bounce</b>        | The email bounced. Marks status as Bounced and stops the cadence.                |
| <b>Call</b>          | A phone call (inbound or outbound) with anyone at the company.                   |
| <b>LinkedIn</b>      | A LinkedIn message, connection request, or InMail.                               |
| <b>Meeting</b>       | An in-person or virtual meeting.                                                 |
| <b>Note</b>          | An internal note -- no outreach took place but you want to record context.       |

### Step-by-Step: How to Log an Event

- 1 Find the company**  
Open it from the [Schedule](#) page, the [Companies](#) list, or the [Dashboard](#) 'Due this week' list.
- 2 Click 'Log Outreach'**  
The button appears on the company detail page and on every row in the [Schedule](#) work queue.
- 3 Select the event type**  
Choose from the dropdown: Initial Email, Follow-Up, Response, Bounce, Call, LinkedIn, Meeting, Note.
- 4 Enter the date**  
Defaults to today (in IST). You can back-date if you are catching up on a past interaction.
- 5 Add a note (optional)**  
Free-text field -- summarise what was said, any next steps, or key context.
- 6 Save**  
The event is appended to the company's history immediately and the cadence recalculates.

### Why Events Cannot Be Edited or Deleted

Outreach events are intentionally permanent. Once saved, an event cannot be changed or removed. This design guarantees an accurate audit trail -- partners and compliance reviewers can always trust the history. If you made a mistake, log a corrective Note event explaining the error.

### How Events Automatically Update Company Status

- Initial Email logged --> status becomes Contacted.
- Response logged --> status becomes Responded (cadence stops).
- Bounce logged --> status becomes Bounced (cadence stops).
- Follow-Up / Call / LinkedIn / Meeting --> status stays Contacted.
- Note --> no status change.

## 9 | Analytics and Reporting

The Analytics section gives your firm data-driven insight into outreach effectiveness. All figures are scoped to your visible mandates.

### Overview (all roles)

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- Total companies and response rate across the entire visible pipeline.
- Count of companies still awaiting first contact.
- Due-this-week and overdue counts as urgency indicators.
- Status breakdown: how many companies are in each stage of the pipeline.

### Response Rate by Bucket (all roles)

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Groups companies by their 'bucket' label and shows the response rate for each segment. Use this to identify which company types or industries are responding best and where the outreach strategy needs to be adjusted.

### By Analyst (Partner only)

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A table showing each analyst's and associate's outreach volume, number of responses obtained, and conversion rate. Partners use this to monitor team productivity, balance workload, and spot high performers.

### Sources Report (all roles)

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Breaks down companies by lead source (Proprietary, Public, Referral, Imported) and cross-references response rates by source quality (High, Medium, Low). Use this to identify the most productive lead channels and decide where to focus business development effort.

## 10 | Settings and Account Management

### Your Profile

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Access Settings from the left sidebar. You can update your display name and view your email address and role. To change your password, enter your current password first for verification.

### Team Management (Partner only)

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Partners can view all team members under Settings. Each member's name, email, role, and assigned mandates are visible. Future releases will include the ability to invite new users and change roles directly from this page.

### Firm Settings

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The firm name and other firm-level details are visible in Settings. These can be updated by a Partner.

**NOTE**

All data in Upstream belongs to your firm exclusively. No data is shared between firms. Each login session is isolated to a single firm's data.

### Data Safety

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Upstream uses industry-standard security practices: passwords are hashed with bcrypt, authentication tokens are stored in secure httpOnly cookies (never in browser localStorage), and all connections are encrypted over HTTPS. Data is stored in a managed PostgreSQL database with daily backups.

## 11 | Quick-Reference Glossary

|                         |                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Mandate</b>          | A deal or engagement (e.g. a sell-side advisory). The top-level container for all CRM activity. |
| <b>Company</b>          | An organisation you are reaching out to -- Target, Buyer, or Investor -- within a mandate.      |
| <b>Contact</b>          | A named person at a company. Tracks title, email, phone, and LinkedIn.                          |
| <b>Outreach Event</b>   | Any recorded interaction: email, call, LinkedIn, meeting, or note. Permanent and append-only.   |
| <b>Initial Email</b>    | The first-ever email to a company. Sets the cadence clock. Can only occur once.                 |
| <b>Follow-Up</b>        | Any email or touch after the initial email, within the cadence schedule.                        |
| <b>Cadence</b>          | The automated follow-up schedule, calculated from the date of the last outreach event.          |
| <b>Cadence Interval</b> | The number of days between follow-ups, set per-company when it is first added.                  |
| <b>AWAITING INITIAL</b> | Schedule state: the initial email has not yet been sent. Clock is not yet running.              |
| <b>ACTIVE (sched.)</b>  | Schedule state: initial email sent; cadence clock running.                                      |
| <b>STOPPED</b>          | Schedule state: cadence has stopped because the company Responded, Declined, or Bounced.        |
| <b>Overdue</b>          | A company whose next follow-up date has already passed.                                         |
| <b>Bucket</b>           | An optional grouping label on a company used in analytics to measure segment performance.       |
| <b>Source</b>           | Where the lead originated: Proprietary, Public, Referral, or Imported.                          |
| <b>Source Quality</b>   | An analyst's rating of the lead quality: High, Medium, or Low.                                  |
| <b>Firm</b>             | The IB firm using Upstream. All data is scoped to one firm -- no cross-firm visibility.         |
| <b>Soft Delete</b>      | Archiving. Data is never permanently deleted; archived items are hidden from active views.      |
| <b>IST</b>              | India Standard Time (UTC+5:30). All cadence dates are computed in IST.                          |
| <b>Partner</b>          | Senior role. Full visibility, mandate management, and firm-wide analytics access.               |
| <b>Analyst</b>          | Junior role. Sees assigned mandates only; logs outreach and manages companies.                  |
| <b>Associate</b>        | Same scope as Analyst. Manages companies and outreach on assigned mandates.                     |
| <b>Primary Contact</b>  | The key person at a company, flagged to appear prominently in list views and reports.           |
| <b>KPI</b>              | Key Performance Indicator -- the five headline numbers shown on the Dashboard.                  |

*Project Upstream -- M&A Deal-Sourcing CRM*

*Built for Upstream Capital Advisors*

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